Google Cloud Security

by Steven Pyper

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Google Cloud Security

BIRDMARKETING.

Google Cloud Platform

Steven Pyper - 40319882
INF07103 Information Systems in Organisations

Google Cloud Security
40319882
INF07103 Information Systems in Organisations

Abstract

The focus of this report is a small marketing company called bird marketing. The main task of this report is to investigate the business systems that are in use at bird marketing as well as finding out what the work culture is like. Research will also be done into the security systems they use to see how effective they are for a small business. A main limitation to this report is that this is second hand information research apart from a single interview. The main method that will be used is academic reading as well as interviews with members of the company that will give insight directly into how the company is run and what it is like to be a part of the company. A main security method used by Bird Marketing is based around the use of the Google Cloud for their servers and to advance their services, this allows for them to focus less on high expense security methods as well as be able to ensure security to their customers. It also allows for them to use Google's security team meaning that Bird Marketing does not have to pay for a expensive employee with security experience, however from an interview with an employee this leads to some issues, they are not able to use certain methods of mail due to the SSH port being blocked through the google servers. Overall it is clear that Bird Marketing has a high requirement for security and reliance on technology, a main recommendation that can be made to companies similar to Bird Marketing should focus on using external security methods such as Google's cloud services to keep expenses down but not risk security flaws to the main part of the business.

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Introduction

Bird marketing is a marketing company that provides multiple kinds of online marketing and hosting services to its customers. They design and develop websites, create online shops, host websites, Pay Per Click advertising and Search Engine Optimisation (SEO). Their market is ever expanding due to the fact that companies that do not own or have good websites will often struggle to be competitive. Bird marketing is a small company based in billericay and has 5 total workers.

Figure 1: Company Structure

Company Culture

An interview was conducted with Project & Technical Manager Jake Alder to discuss the company culture. Jake said that “At Bird Marketing there is a heavy focus on having control stay at the top of the company to allow faster decisions to be made, this allows for us to react faster to the market as well as allow the rest of the company to get on with their jobs” (Alder, 2017). This slots into Handy’s power culture definition, Handy said that “Power culture typical of the owner-managed, entrepreneurial firm where power is concentrated in the hands of a single person”.(Handy, 1993). There is a focus on allowing for quick decisions and keeping the power concentrated to the top by the owner. This leads to a fairly centralised company meaning that those at the top create the rules and make the decisions and

those at the bottom must follow them, this allows for increased coordination and enables Economies of scale. Jake also said that “Technology is a huge part of our work, we use it on a daily basis and any advantage we can get from technology over a competitor is extremely important” (Alder, 2017). This shows a positive attitude towards technological change at this company due to the fact it is built upon competing in a growing market and having advantages especially technologically can lead to gaining ground over competitors.

Environment

Using McFarlan and McKenney’s Strategic Grid Analysis Bird Marketing's use of technology is clearly strategic as technology is a permanent requirement every day for the company to function correct. This is due to the fact that every job that Bird Marketing does is based around the internet and is required to be competitive (McFarlan, McKenney & Pyburn 1983). The environment that Bird Marketing is in is full of competitors and is fast changing, analysis of this is important in showing how crucial technology is in their environment. This Pestel analysis shows that the environment that Bird Marketing is in is a very positive one (see appendix 1 for full Pestel Analysis).

Figure 2: Pestel analysis

Inputs-Processes-Outputs

There are many different kinds of inputs, processes and outputs for a web development company such as Bird Marketing, this is due to the amount of services providing, the wide variety of options inside those services and the fact that it is a soft system meaning that there will always be some sort of change to the inputs processes and outputs, such as the potential for the customer to change their initial request and specification meaning that the outputted implementation becomes a input. Figure 3 gives a summary of the input-process-output, the main inputs of Bird Marketing come from a customer placing a request of one of the many of the services provided by the company, this would give a specification to the company manager who would then process it and decide whether it is a job they would wish to do, this is then passed onto either the SEO & PPC executive or Technical and Project manager depending on the job. They would then work on the job to create it and once completely pass it back to the customer. If the customer was happy they would finalise and implement it, if the customer was not happy the design would be worked on to the new and updated specification. This would loop until the customer was happy with the design.

Figure 3: Generalised Input-Process-Output

Security methods

The main Security method used by Bird Marketing is through Google's Cloud service, this has many benefits particularly to security for a company like Bird Marketing. Rountree argued that "there are two aspects to security controls in cloud implementations. The first has to do with the presence of the control. The second aspect is the effectiveness or robustness of the control" (Rountree & Castrillo 2014). This shows that there are two important parts to cloud security, one being the actual security itself and the other being how the customer can affect the security to not hamper either the cloud owner or customer. Although Bird Marketing loses some of the control over their security this is balanced by the fact that Bird Marketing no longer needs deal with it themselves and leaves it to Google which lowers the expenses of software and servers to focus that would have focused on security and backups. This also allows for customers of Bird Marketing to know that any of the work they request will be kept safely and securely because it is using Google's infrastructure which has a lot of backing to keep it secure. Google gives companies that use its cloud service multiple types of security such as:

- Vulnerability management
- Malware prevention
- Monitoring
- Incident management
- Data Loss Prevention
- Phishing prevention

Through all of these methods large amount of security can be given to customers of Google's cloud services (Google, 2017). This also gives more benefits to the company such as the fact that there should not be downtime for Bird Marketing as Google's data Centres have backups in places such as having all data on multiple data centres and backup generators, this is especially important for Bird Marketing as they heavily rely on using these systems to generate income therefore the high uptime allows for high levels of efficiency and consistency within the company.

Conclusion

Overall, Bird Marketing is a company with a heavy focus on technology and security in its daily running of the company. With such a heavy focus it comes with no surprise that having a system that is consistent and has a high uptime is important to the company, with this the use of the Google cloud servers this allows them to achieve this. It gives Bird Marketing a step up over competitors who do their own security as they are able to reallocate funds elsewhere in the company as well as have up to date security measures in place for them meaning that they do not need someone with as much security experience. If companies are in a similar position to Bird Marketing it could only be advised to follow this particular route as it leads to many perceived benefits without the drawbacks of having a on team member who could do the security for the company.

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Rountree, D., & Castrillo, I. (2014). The basics of cloud computing : : Understanding the fundamentals of cloud computing in theory and practice. Waltham, Mass.: Syngress.

Google. (July 21, 2017) Google Security Whitepaper Retrieved from https://cloud.google.com/security/whitepaper

Appendice

Figure 2 - Pestel analysis

Political - in the interview with Jake he revealed that since the EU referendum people have been moving away from PPC advertising due to fears that when the UK finally leaves the EU that there will be changes to laws affecting advertising and the treatment of Google through politicians.

Economic - Bird Marketing is in a position where the economy is growing around them as more companies are moving to web based services that will require websites and advertising, as such they are able to make us of this to generate extra income from new customers. However due to the EU referendum there has been a decline in customers for certain services due to uncertainty with finance.

Social - The ever growing expectations for companies in this highly competitive market creates a threat to the company that they are unable to ever do a bad job because it will negatively impact business reputation. This adds extra pressure to the workers in bird marketing can lead to extra social pressures in their own social life.

Technological - as technology is such an important part of bird market it is clearly a large influence in the company, technology is always changing and getting better therefore Bird Marketing must focus on keeping up to date to not fall behind in the market, this leads to extra pressure and expenses to keep the company competitive

Environmental- The environment that the company is in is growing fast due to a surge in online presence from most companies of all size; this has led to an ever growing need for websites and online advertising. All of this has led to an extremely competitive market and a lot of competition, this adds extra stress to all those involved in the company but also gives many opportunities to find new workers as well as more work in general.

Legal- As Bird Marketing focuses heavily on online advertising and hosting they are bound by laws such as data protection and many other laws that they need to be

careful of, there is a change coming up to many of these laws that may affect themselves and customers, this could cause a stir up in the environment they are in as some companies might not be able to change quick enough to keep up with these changes and this could lead to an increase in orders that they might not be able to keep up with.

Overall, Bird Marketing has the room to continue to expand and grow in the market due to the increasing amount of companies looking to expand online, there has been sustained growth in the market and as technologies improve there are many opportunities for a burst of growth for bird marketing. However there are also many pitfalls in the environment that Bird marketing must be careful of, such as changes to the legal system that must be followed and adjusted to quickly and effectively, they must also keep updated with the new technologies as they become available to not fall behind.

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Google Cloud Security

GRADEMARK REPORT

FINAL GRADE

80 /100

GENERAL COMMENTS

Instructor

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GRADING FORM: ISO REPORT

STEVEN
PYPER

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CRITERION 1 ABSTRACT

This is too much information and is better suited in the introduction.

5

CRITERION 2 INTRODUCTION

Introduction, including definitions and examples

Good.

8

CRITERION 3 ANALYSIS

Depth and detail of your report

Strong analysis with relevant examples.

8

CRITERION 4 CONSISTENCY

Consistency and logic of your report

Flows well.

9

CRITERION 5 SWOT

SWOT/PEST analysis

Strong pestel analysis.

9

CRITERION 6 EVIDENCE

Evidence of latest developments in the technology or practice

Evidence from interview should have been supported with references from reading.

7

CRITERION 7 STRUCTURE

Structure and organisation of your essay

Well structured.

8

CRITERION 8

Conclusion

Strong conclusion.

9

CRITERION 9 COMPANT

Company structure illustration

Well illustrated and discussed with clear examples and tools.

9

CRITERION 10 REFERENCES

Range, currency and appropriateness of your sources and references and accuracy of references in the body of the text and consistency with list at the end

Good list. More citations in text needed.

8